

HOLDING TO ACCOUNT

Legitimate accountability has three conditions, it was agreed, the person controls it, and you helped unblock it.

How to demand results without becoming a toxic boss.

THE QUESTION OF THIS PIECE

Do you have the licence to demand this?

THE CASCADE

The pressure that only produces defense.



WHAT YOU SEE

You push on the feeling that it is slow...



THE MECHANISM

...the person spends the meeting defending herself...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the real problem sits exactly where it was.

Pressure with no fact is an opinion, and an opinion is answered with an excuse.

THE FORK

Before you open your mouth, check three things.

CHECK THREE THINGS

01



Was it agreed clearly? If not, you cannot demand it.

02



Does she control this result? If not, it is useless weight.

03



Did you unblock what she asked for? If not, the debt is yours.

Without the three, you are not demanding a result, you are venting frustration.

THE METHOD

The licence to hold to account, three conditions.



01 AGREED

there is a written agreement, with number, date and owner

02 IN THEIR CONTROL

the result depends on decisions she can actually make

03 SUPPORT GIVEN

the blocker she flagged was removed, or explained

With the three in hand, the conversation takes ten minutes and ends in a plan.

WHAT TO ASK, IN ORDER

Four sentences that pull without crushing.

01 • AGREED

We agreed on eighty, we are at fifty two.

start with the fact, no adjective and no verdict in the tone

02 • IN THEIR
CONTROL**What is actually blocking it?**

an open question before any conclusion of yours

03 • SUPPORT
GIVEN**What do I need to fix on my side?**

the sentence that separates a manager from an executioner

04

So where does that leave us, and when do we look again?

every accountability talk ends in a plan with a date, never a sermon

TWO MODELS

Demanding by fear or by method.

THE COMMON MODEL

By fear

Arrives with a feeling

Talks about the person's effort

Pushes in front of others

Ends with a vague warning

THE DESIGNED MODEL

By method

Arrives with a number and a trend

Talks about the agreed result

Pushes in a direct conversation

Ends with a plan and a date

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three habits that corrode the team.

01 Pushing in front of everyone.

- an audience turns correction into humiliation, and nobody forgets.

02 Pushing on what changes priority every week.

- whoever chases a moving target stops chasing.

03 Pushing and never acknowledging when it lands.

- a team that only hears from you on failure learns to hide problems.

Pressure with no recognition becomes noise, and the team mutes it.

THE CHAIN

The reaction test.

01

Watch the person when you sit down to talk about results.



02

Does she start explaining herself, before any question?



03

Then your pressure has become fear, and fear hides problems.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Whoever fears you delivers a pretty report and a hidden problem.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

How to prepare the next conversation.



STEP 01

Reread what was agreed, with the number and the date.

half of these conversations die here, the agreement was vague



STEP 02

Bring the trend, not only today's number.

the trend tells the story better than the snapshot



STEP 03

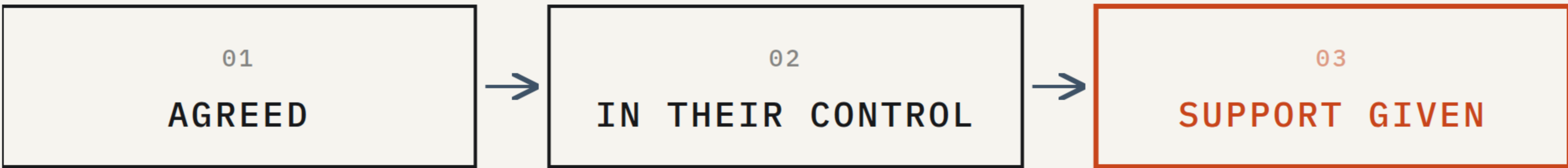
Open with the question, what is blocking it?

and listen all the way through before proposing anything

A good accountability conversation ends with you holding a task too.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Licence to Ask, in the order that matters.



A boss pushes with temperament. A manager pushes with an agreement.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

before your next accountability conversation.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA